

Yaqi Li

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Cambridge, MA

Computation and Cognition (6-9) & Design Minor (4)

Sep. 2024 - May 2028

Activities: MIT Hacking Medicine, Global Teaching Lab, Design Plus, Club Golf

GPA: 4.8/5.0

Relevant Coursework: Topics in Multiagent Learning, Robotics: Science and Systems, Intro to Algorithms, Intro to Machine Learning, Computational Design and Fabrication, AI in Decision Making and Society, Probability & Statistics

EXPERIENCES

Multisensory Intelligence Group, MIT Media Lab/CSAIL

Aug. 2025 – Present

Research Intern

Cambridge, MA

- Designed and implemented a sim-to-real pipeline for a modular soft arm in MuJoCo, using k-NN inverse control that cut prediction error $\sim 90\%$ vs. a constant-curvature baseline (4.2 vs. 43 mm) for autonomous target reaching and 2D/3D path following (~ 6 mm mean error).
- Redesigned and fabricated a modular, cable-driven soft robotic arm using 3D-printed PLA disks and flexible PLA panels, actuated by Arduino-controlled motors, with conductive-PLA contact sensors at the tip for touch sensing.
- Collected and analyzed multimodal OpenTouch Dataset containing 5.1 hours of synchronized video-touch-pose data and 2,900 curated clips with detailed text annotations.

Signal Ocean

May 2026 – Aug. 2026

Intern

London, UK

- Built and deployed an end-to-end LLM agent in production with 5 parallel evidence-gathering tools to investigate and fix errors in an AIS-derived maritime voyage pipeline covering $\sim 56,000$ vessels.
- Improved label accuracy from 59% to 95% on a 60-case frozen benchmark by developing an LLM-as-judge evaluation harness, combining ~ 40 curator-taught rules with 8 deterministic checks per stop and iterative error analysis.
- Reduced per-ticket investigation time from ~ 1.5 hrs to 30–90s (~ 575 analyst hours/year recoverable) with a human-in-the-loop approval UI feeding a self-improving case bank.

MIT Hacking Medicine

Aug. 2025 – Present

Program Lead

Cambridge, MA

- Led marketing and design for tech- and healthcare-focused hackathons and partner events, organizing and leading the annual GrandHack with 500+ participants in collaboration with engineering, medicine, and business teams.
- Co-organized 10+ global partner hack initiatives reaching $\sim 4,000$ total participants, collaborating with local hospitals, healthcare organizations, and industry partners to develop outreach and event strategies.

Liu Lab, National University of Singapore

Jun. 2025 – Aug. 2025

Research Intern

Singapore, Singapore

- Applied computational optimization methods (Python, COMSOL, AutoCAD) to parameterize neural interface geometry and improve device fabrication success by 300%.
- Fabricated and optimized 100+ self-expansive hydrogel-based cauda equina neural interface (CENI) for high-precision bioelectric signal capture.

Critical Matter Group, MIT Media Lab

Dec. 2024 – May. 2025

Research Intern

Cambridge, MA

- Built AI-driven generative pipelines (text-to-3D, text-to-video) to study language-conditioned creative systems.
- Prototyped interactive HCI systems for “Gaze to the Stars” project, integrating eye-tracking and multimodal data collection for large-scale installations with 200+ participants.

SKILLS

Skills: Agentic AI Development, Multimodal ML, Algorithm Development, RL, LLM, Product Design, Data Analysis

Coding Languages & Tools: Python, Java, MATLAB, Mathematica, Javascript, R, PyTorch, COMSOL

Multiphysics, AutoCAD, Mathematica, Excel, DeepLabCut, Simba, Keypoint MoSeq

Spoken Languages: English (Native), Mandarin (Native)